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QUALITY ASSURANCE MANUAL GARMENTS

FACTORY VISIT PROCEDURES

Before visit

- Verify vendor is on Global Compliance's approved vendor list
- Obtain factory contact name, phone number and address.
- Secure fabric/yarn color swatches and/or hand and finish standards
- Obtain the approved sample
- Obtain and check the following documents:
 1. Copies of Purchase Order
 2. Manufacturing specifications
 3. Additional reports relative to production being inspected
 4. Approved production schedules.

Upon visit

- Verify factory owns required machinery for attaching buttons (lock-stitch machines), snaps (machines and snap supplier is on approved vendor list)
- Verify factory has testing and in-house monitoring systems in place for safety and performance issues
- Verify factory has needle control procedures in place and maintains a current broken needle log.

ACCEPTABLE QUALITY LEVEL (AQL)

AQL is a method is used to define a production order sample to determine if the entire product order has met the client's specifications.

Gap Inc.'s A.Q.L. standards when appraising a vendor's manufacturing process during shipment audits are as follows:

- 0.1 for appraising Critical Visual Defects
- 0.25 for OCR/Ticket Defects
- 4.0 or 2.5 for appraising Major Visual Defects
- 6.5 for appraising Minor Visual Defects
- 6.5 for appraising Major Measurement Defects



IN PROCESS INSPECTION

The primary purpose of an In-Process inspection is to monitor key production steps to identify potential issues early. Defects identified during inspections should be documented in In-Process reports, which serve as the foundation for data collection and evaluation.

Cutting Inspection Procedures

- Verify and record fabric test reports.
- After cutting, perform visual and measurement, inspection of cut parts using the In-Process Visual Inspection Report.

Trim & Sewing Inspection Procedures

- Make sure all fabric, trims, and labels meet approved standards, include the right country of origin, and list correct fibre content and are available so production schedules can be met.
- Inspect sewing lines randomly. Ensure each operator's work is checked for defects, and record the findings.
- Verify needle control and safety procedures are being followed.
- Measure placement, size of pattern pieces, size and seam construction against specification sheet.
- Record and indicate any problems in the space provided in the In-Process Visual Inspection Worksheet.
- Talk to factory management about the problems and suggest solutions and if the factory can't fix the issue, contact the merchandiser or production representative for further action.

GAP INTERNATIONAL SOURCING (_____OFFICE

RANDOM/UNANNOUNCED ☐
IN LINE (SCHEDULED) ☐

STYLE NO. _____	CONTRACT SHIPMENT DATE _____	INSPECTION DATE: _____
P.O. NO. _____	ANTICIPATED SHIPMENT DATE _____	INSPECTION LOCATION _____
_____	ORDER QUANTITY _____	VENDOR: _____
DEPT.: _____	COLOR: _____	FACTORY: _____
FABRIC TEST # _____		FACTORY CODE _____
PRODUCT DESCRIPTION: _____		AUDITOR: _____

	FACTORY	COUNTRY LOCATION	SAME AS IN-LINE ONE			
FABRIC/KNIT PANEL			☐	YES	☐	NO
CUTTING			☐	YES	☐	NO
MINOR SEWING			☐	YES	☐	NO
MAJOR SEWING/ ASSEMBLED/ LOOPING			☐	YES	☐	NO
FINISHING			☐	YES	☐	NO

ACTUAL PRODUCTION STATUS: ☐ FABRIC(EG. BLANKETS ☐ KTS. PANEL ☐ ASSEMBLY

FABRIC CUTTING	SEWING	FINISHING	LINKING/LOOPING/ MENDING	SAFETY CHECK
☐ SHADING	☐ THREAD	☐ WASHING	☐ SEAM/ LK/ LP	☐ NEEDLE CONTR
☐ STRIPE MATCH	☐ SEAM	☐ CLR FASTNES	☐ KNITTING	☐ LOCKSTITCH BUT
☐ CUTTING REPORTS	☐ STITCH	☐ CLEANING	☐ MEND	☐ PULL TESTING
☐ PATTERN	☐ SHAPES/SYMMETR	☐ PRESSING	☐ BTN/ HOLES	☐ NECK STRETCH G
☐ MARKER	☐ BUTTON HOLES	☐ FOLDING	☐ BARTACKING	☐ NEEDLE DETECT
☐ PLY MATCHING	☐ POCKETING	☐ TICKETING	☐ OTHER	☐ SNAP MACHINE
	☐ LABEL POSITION	☐ HANGTAGS		☐ SNAP TEST
☐ OTHER	☐ HEMMING	☐ POLYBAG		
	☐ BARTACKING	☐ CARTON		
	☐ LINING	☐ MARKINGS		
	☐ SPECS	☐ PACKING		

N/A = NOT APPLICABLE

CONFIRMED & SIGNED BY VENDOR / FACTORY REPRESENTATIVE

DATE _____

Q.A. MANAGER INITIALS / DATE ||

VENDOR _____ MFG. PLANT _____ DIVISION _____ DATE _____
 LINE No. _____ STYLE _____ PATTERN _____ AUDITOR _____

[illegible]

Q.A. SIGNATURE (DATE) _____ LINE SUPERVISOR _____ PLANT MANAGER _____

FAX WEEKLY TO: _____
FAX NUMBER: _____
FROM: _____
P.O. NUMBER(if available) _____

VENDOR: _____
SUBCONTRACTOR: _____
WEEK OF: _____

INSTRUCTIONS: Use separate sheet for each vendor or subcontractor

[illegible]

Percent defective (divide total units defective by total units inspected): Vertical Placement: _____
Horizontal Placement: _____

In-Process Graphics Worksheet (optional)

SHIPMENT INSPECTION

Purpose: To evaluate order quality through visual checks, measurements, and packing assessment.

Objective: Minimize defective products reaching Gap Inc. distribution centers, stores, and other locations.

Inspection Methods

Combined audit

during packing (Measurements, Visuals, Packaging, and Packing).

Non-Destructive audit

before boxing (Measurements, Visuals, and Packaging) during boxing.

Procedures & Responsibilities

- **Pre-shipment inspection plan (scope, criteria, sampling).**
- **Visual inspection (defects, damages).**
- **Dimensional inspection (measurements, tolerances).**
- **Functional testing (zippers, buttons, etc.).**
- **Documentation review (packing lists, invoices).**
- **Non-conformance reporting (defects, discrepancies).**
- **Inspecting products against agreed-upon standards.**
- **Documenting findings and issuing reports.**
- **Communicating findings to relevant parties.**
- **Recommending corrective actions.**
- **Ensuring timely shipment release.**

MEASUREMET AUDIT

Procedures & Criteria

- Define scope (garments, styles, sizes).
- Prepare checklist (measurements, tolerances).
- Select representative samples (random sampling).
- Conduct measurements (calibrated tools).
- Analyze data (identify deviations).
- Generate report (summarize findings, recommendations).
- Implement corrective actions.
- Criteria:Accuracy (meet tolerances)
- Consistency (across samples)
- Reproducibility (reliable results)
- Traceability (track measurements)
- Compliance (meet standards & specs)

MEASUREMENT AUDIT

Sampling Plan & Acceptance Criteria

SAMPLING PLAN

To determine the number of garments to inspect from a larger production lot. Inspecting the entire lot would be impractical and time-consuming. A representative sample allows for a reasonable assessment of the overall quality of the production run.

MINOR DEFECT LIMITS

Minor defects are measurement deviations that fall outside the specified tolerance but do not exceed the defined "grade" for that measurement.
Woven/Knit: 10% of measurement points allowed out of tolerance within grade.
Sweater: 15% of measurement points allowed out of tolerance within grade.

AUDIT FAILURE

If minor or major defect limits are exceeded, the audit fails.
Notify the merchandiser/production representative for corrective action.
Rectifying the defective garments or Conducting a re-inspection of the entire lot

VISUAL AUDIT

A visual audit in the garment industry is a process that involves examining garments for defects and inconsistencies. It can be performed on fabrics, garments, or packaging.

At relevant stages of the Visual Audit, the following forms are used:

- Visual Inspection Report
- Visual Inspection Worksheet

Visual Audit Methods

1) Non-Destructive Visual Audit, performed before the garments are boxed

2) Visual Auditing begins after the boxing/packing process has started.

VISUAL AUDIT PROCEDURES

1

Multi-day Audits: Results recorded on Visual Inspection Worksheet must be reviewed, signed by factory management, transferred, and attached to the Visual Inspection Report.

2

Defect Counting: Pass/fail numbers for minor/major defects must be counted separately.

3

OCR Information: Any trim containing OCR (BARCODE) information must be audited. Additional audits are required if incorrect OCR trim/label/ticket is detected.

4

Major Defects Examples include Incorrect size strip, flasher, logo label, non-OCR (BARCODE) price ticket

5

Lot Size & Sampling: Random sample selection is based on quantity, sizes, and colors. Sample size depends on lot size and used sampling plan. Samples must be taken randomly, including all sizes.

6

Complete the Visual Inspection Report. Record the fabric/production test reports numbers in the appropriate area.

7

More than one major defect per product counted as one major defect.
Consistent Minor Defects: Consistent minor defects affecting product appearance will fail the shipment audit.

8

During the shipment audit, packaging and labeling should be checked closely to insure conformance to standards including proper Country of Origin and fiber content markings.

9

When multiple Purchase Orders are ready for shipment, they can be combined and the audit performed on a sample taken from this combination. If the audit fails, all Purchase Orders fail; if it passes all Purchase Orders pass.

Critical Defects

Gap representatives must ensure immediate corrective action for any defects found to prevent recurrence.

- **Critical Visual Defects:** Based on A.Q.L. of 0.1 for all divisions.
- **OCR/Ticket/Label Check:** Based on a 0.25 A.Q.L.
- **Major Visual Defects:** A.Q.L. of 4.0 for Gap Divisions & Old Navy, 2.5 for Banana Republic & products for Japan.
- **Minor Visual Defects:** A.Q.L. of 6.5 for all divisions.

Audit Pass/Fail Criteria

If the audit fails, new audit date is recorded in the comment column. Then same audit procedures are followed.

- If the number of visual defects is equal to or less than the number allowed per the sampling plan, the audit passes. Defective products sent back for repair or seconded.
- Audit fails if visual defects more than allowed; notify merchandiser/production representative for determination.

Gap / Old Navy Procedures

Sweaters: Weigh three pieces of the median size; calculate average weight.

babyGap Fine Knits: Weigh three pieces of every size; record individual readings; forward results to babyGap merchants.

Gap Asia Pacific Procedures

No shipment audit for new store orders or quantities $\leq 1,000$ units by color; vendor responsible for audit and quality adherence.

Banana Republic Procedures

Weigh four sweaters of every size; record results; calculate average weight; compute overall weight based on size ratio.

Seconds & Overruns

Vendors must remove all Gap Inc. logos, labels, or other identification before selling seconds or overruns to others; schedule audits to verify proper removal.

PACK AUDIT

Before the actual shipment of cartons there is a inspection done by both factory and buyer representative in order to ensure that the cartons meet the quality standards.

Key terms:

- **Factory Audit (FA):** Conducted by the vendor/factory to check packing compliance.
- **Audit Assessment (AA):** Performed by Gap Inc. QA as a secondary validation.
- **Purpose:** Ensures quality, labeling accuracy, and adherence to shipment standards

Pack Audit Procedures

Factory/vendor responsible for performing the pack audit as a separate process.

QA personnel must:

- **Review factory audit results before beginning.**
- **Place an "AA" mark on audited boxes in the upper right corner (1"x1" space).**
- **Ensure FA and AA marks are not covered with tape or labels.**
- **10% of factory-audited boxes are assessed by Gap Inc. QA.**

Major Defects in Pack Audits

- **Quantity errors:** Incorrect items or amounts.
- **Labeling issues:** Missing or wrong carton labels.
- **Pre-pack errors:**
 - Incorrect assortments or quantities.
 - Errors in pre-pack stickers.
- **Carton quality issues:**
 - Incorrect size, construction, or damaged cartons.
 - Prohibited use of wire/metal straps for sealing cartons.

Re-Audit and Corrective Actions

- **Upon failure, corrective action is mandatory:**
 - Factory must document and share an action plan to fix errors.
 - A re-audit is conducted to confirm corrections.
- **Results are recorded in a Visual Inspection Report and attached to the original audit report**



Full Carton/CD Flow Pack Programs

Prototype Packs :

- Vendors must maintain pre-approved prototype packs for training.
- Audit larger populations in stages to minimize extra handling if errors are found.
- Same criteria for major packing errors apply to Full Carton Pack Audits.

Vendor Responsibilities

Vendors must establish packing audit systems and follow sampling plans.
Improperly packed shipments lead to:
Vendor-incurred costs for corrections at Gap Inc.'s Distribution Centers.

Sampling Plan

Uses ANSI/ASQC Z1.4 1993 Single Sampling Plan with a 0.65 AQL level.

# of Cartons	Sample size	pass	fail
5-15	3	0	1
16-50	8	0	1
51-150	20	0	1
151-500	50	1	2

OUTLET DIVISION STANDARDS

Outlet Audit Forms

At the relevant stage of an Outlet Audit, use the following form:

- **Visual Inspection Report**
- **Gap Factory Outlet Inspection Report**



OUTLET DIVISION AUDITING TYPES

All rejected products must first be offered to the Outlet Division. There are three types of audits for Outlet:

1

First quality product sold to or produced for Outlet with Outlet labels. Apply same methods for audit as any Gap Inc. division. This audit will be recorded on the Visual Inspection Report.

2

First-quality products sold or produced for the Outlet, featuring Banana Republic, Gap, GapKids, or babyGap labels crossed through with a gold pen, are inspected using the most current A.Q.L. standards and documented on the Visual Inspection Report.

3

Products rejected by merchandising or production but purchased by the Outlet undergo an audit to ensure they meet Outlet standards, such as being free from packing errors or third-quality defects, with results documented on the Gap Factory Outlet Inspection Report.



SECONDS & OVERRUNS

SECONDS

Seconds Garments are defined as those that are wearable with unnoticeable flaws. These defects should not be conspicuous to the average customer.

This is only a reference tool. All seconds, overruns, unused goods or rejected goods of any kind must still be offered to Outlet

Outlet is generally interested in first quality or seconds.

All seconds, overruns, unused, or rejected goods must be offered to Outlet.

Outlet focuses on first quality or seconds; thirds are referenced but not prioritized.

VENDOR MUST SEND 3 SAMPLES:

- 2 reflecting majority of flaws.
- 1 representing the worst-case scenario (clearly indicated).

SAFETY PROCEDURES

It is mandatory that all raw materials, trim components, and actual production garments be evaluated by a Gap, Inc. approved testing laboratory.

The following are QA procedures when performing a Safety audit:

- **Needle Control: Verify and sign Needle Control Procedure Log,**
 - **Confirm factory's understanding of needle control procedures.**
 - **Ask factory management and operators to explain needle control procedures.**
 - **ensure it's up-to-date and properly filled.**
 - **Photocopy the latest entry; attach to the report.**
 - **Check needle detector if factory has one.**
 - **Check date of machine's last service and calibration. Test machine and it's sensitivity adjustment.**
 - **Review occurrence log for needles that have been detected.**
 - **Check for lock-stitch button machines.**
 - **Check snap equipment and parts to make sure they are on the approved list of suppliers.**
 - **Hand/foot press or flywheel equipment is not allowed.**

BROKEN NEEDLE STANDARDS

Verification of Factory's Needle Control Procedures :

- Walk through production lines to confirm needle control procedures before audits.
- Randomly ask operators to explain the correct procedure for broken needles; proceed with audit if correct, otherwise, discuss findings with factory management.
- Inspect the floor, around machines, and under machine heads for broken/spare needles; collect and save findings for discussion with management.
- Verify log accuracy; sign and date if complete. Ensure all broken parts are taped to the log; investigate if incomplete.
- Vendors with detection equipment must calibrate hourly using a 1.2mm check card and maintain a log of findings.
- Contaminated needles must be disposed of in a bloodborne pathogen container.

BROKEN NEEDLE FORMS

At relevant stages of the Broken Needle Inspection, use Broken Needle Log



BROKEN NEEDLE PROCEDURES

The following are Needle procedures for vendors when manufacturing garment:

- Operators should not possess any spare needles.
 - Replacement needles should be stored in a locked closet.
 - Worn needles should be disposed of in a sealed container.
 - When needles break, every effort must be made to locate all fragments.
 - If all fragments cannot be found, component or garment must be destroyed.
 - Breakage must be recorded in the broken needle log.
 - Broken or used needles should not be around machines or on factory floor.
 - Pins, staples, wire or metal clips should not be used in the bundling, sewing or laundry process.
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THANK YOU